

Business Strategy Doc

Strategy

The strategy for our travel planner app is to help everyday travelers plan their next vacation with confidence by combining trip itinerary building with real-time budget tracking, so users know exactly what they can afford before they book. Designed for frequent leisure travelers who want more financial control over their trips, the app is offered at \$1.99, making it accessible with no recurring fees or subscription fatigue. Beyond the initial purchase, the app generates ongoing revenue through affiliate partnerships with booking platforms like Booking.com and Expedia, earning a small commission whenever users book flights, hotels, or activities directly through the app. This model keeps the app low-cost and appealing to download while creating a sustainable revenue stream tied to the very trips users are already planning.

Objective

The main business objective of Paradise Planner is to make trip planning easier, faster, and more organized for users who are trying to balance destination choices with a limited budget. The application should help users answer important questions such as where to go, where to stay, how to travel, what activities to include, and whether the overall trip fits within their expected budget. A successful result would be a user being able to create and organize a complete trip more efficiently with Paradise Planner than by manually searching multiple websites and keeping track of all the information separately.

Justification

Travel planning is often fragmented because travelers must use different websites or applications for flights, hotels, activities, transportation, and budgeting. This creates additional work because the traveler must compare information from several sources and then manually organize the results. Our research indicates that cost and available activities or events are major factors when people make travel decisions. Paradise Planner addresses this problem by bringing the most important planning information together and allowing users to see how different choices affect their overall trip. The project is justified because it addresses a common and practical problem: travelers need a simpler way to understand the cost, timing, and activities involved in a trip before making final decisions. By reducing the number of separate tools required, Paradise Planner can make the planning process easier to understand and more efficient.

Scope:

Paradise Planner will focus on helping users organize trips and make major travel decisions.

The application will support:

- Choosing and comparing destinations.

- Reviewing hotel or lodging options.
- Comparing flights or other transportation options.
- Estimating major expenses such as lodging, flights, gas, food, and activities.
- Finding relevant activities and events at the destination.
- Organizing activities, costs, and times into a day-by-day itinerary.
- Viewing an estimated total trip cost.
- Redirecting users to external travel providers when a booking or purchase needs to be completed outside the application.

The project does not attempt to become a complete booking platform or provide information about every event occurring at every destination. Paradise Planner is primarily a planning and decision-support tool. Trips will also be planned within approximately 12 months.

Where the Chain Breaks and Why?

The greatest risk of the chain breaking occurs between the application's features and the expected business outcome. Paradise Planner depends on external sources for information such as hotel prices, flights, events, and other travel data. If that information is unavailable, outdated, incomplete, or incompatible with the application, users may not receive enough useful information to make effective trip decisions.

Another possible break occurs when users are redirected to external providers. Paradise Planner can help users compare and organize their choices, but it cannot fully control the experience after a user leaves the application to complete a booking.

There is also a risk if the project scope becomes too large. Attempting to include every event, every travel service, or full booking functionality could make the application more complicated and move the project away from its main purpose.

For this reason, the team should protect the chain by focusing development on the features that directly support the main objective: cost visibility, destination decisions, transportation, lodging, activities, and simple day-by-day trip organization.